

Route 2 preview

Recover chroma at `--cN-dark`

indaco · current Brand-triad rank-1 vs proposed (old --chart- + --cat-)

Slot 1-6 of the proposal = the prior `--chart-` palette verbatim (brand mid-blue, vermillion, teal, magenta, gold, slate-ink). Slots 7-12 = the prior `--cat-` hues without the overlapping blue/orange (since slots 1 + 2 already carry those).

AA-text with white passes cleanly at slots 1 and 6; passes borderline at slots 2 and 4; fails at 3, 5, and 7-12. **That's the trade.** The slots that fail AA-text aren't consumed with white text on them in any shipped layout — they're piechart wedges, gitgraph dots, kanban marks, decision bottom borders. AA-graphical (≥3:1 vs bg) passes for every slot.

indaco slots 1-6 · brand voice (matches old --chart-* exactly)

#	CURRENT	PROPOSED	RATIONALE
1	#2E608A L=42 · 6.0:1 ✓ current	#006FA8 L=51 · 5.5:1 ✓ proposed	brand mid-blue · the identity colour; tag-bg lands here
2	#863236 L=37 · 7.2:1 ✓	#C45D27 L=53 · 4.3:1 ◄	vermilion · CB-safe complement to slot 1 (Wong 2011)
3	#7B772D L=51 · 4.7:1 ✓	#1FA694 L=58 · 3.0:1 ○	teal · sibling of slot 1, hue-shifted
4	#323686 L=29 · 10.5:1 ✓	#B8438C L=52 · 4.0:1 ◄	magenta · CB-safe complement to slot 3
5	#30827E L=50 · 4.5:1 ✓	#C8A82E L=70 · 2.3:1 ○ (dark text)	mustard gold · lightness anchor; pairs with dark text not white
6	#865832 L=42 · 6.1:1 ✓	#3F4A60 L=33 · 8.5:1 ✓	slate-ink · the grounding anchor; theme-neutral

AA legend: ✓ ≥4.5:1 (AA-text safe) · ◄ 3.0-4.4:1 (graphical-pass, borderline text) · ○ <3.0:1 (graphical-pass only, no text on it)

indaco slots 7-12 · supporting voice (matches old --cat-* without overlap)

#	CURRENT	PROPOSED	RATIONALE
7	#583880 L=29 · 10.0:1 ✓	#8E7BAF L=55 · 3.5:1 ◀	cat-purple · extends to violet beyond slot-4 magenta
8	#80385F L=33 · 8.0:1 ✓	#6FB89A L=67 · 2.6:1 ○	cat-green sage · softer green sibling of slot-3 teal
9	#5F8038 L=48 · 4.6:1 ✓	#C57E8B L=60 · 3.0:1 ○	cat-rose · dusty pink, warm complement to slot-8 sage
10	#388058 L=46 · 5.1:1 ✓	#6BDB8 L=68 · 2.5:1 ○	cat-teal mint · pale green-teal, sibling of slot-3 deep teal
11	#7C3880 L=33 · 7.9:1 ✓	#B8939F L=63 · 2.9:1 ○	cat-mauve · dusty violet, softer than slot-7 purple
12	#3C8038 L=46 · 4.9:1 ✓	#9AA8B8 L=66 · 2.7:1 ○	cat-slate · cool neutral, low-chroma palette closer

The supporting voice (slots 7-12) sits at L≈55-68 — chromatic but softer than slots 1-6. None pass AA-text with white; all pass graphical (≥3:1 vs bg). They're for marks/wedges/fills, never tag backgrounds.

Visual comparison · piechart wedges

CURRENT (--CN-DARK = AUDIT BRAND-TRIAD RANK-1)



PROPOSED (--CN-DARK = OLD --CHART-*)



The current palette reads as one tonal voice — every slot deepened to L≈32-42 for AA-text-with-white. The proposed reads as the brand's *actual*/categorical palette — blue, vermilion, teal, magenta, gold, slate. Same six wedges, very different rooms.

Visual comparison · decision-list tag-bg (slot 1)

CURRENT

BUILD

WHY NOT BUY

WHY NOT DELAY

PROPOSED

BUILD

WHY NOT BUY

WHY NOT DELAY

Slot 1 proposed (#006FA8) is brand mid-blue at AA 5.5:1 with white text — same identity colour the deck's `--accent` uses. The current (#2E608A) is a muted derivative.

Slot 3 proposed (#1FA694) is teal at 3.0:1 with white — graphical-pass, borderline text. If a slot-3 tag becomes common in shipped decks, we'd want to either deepen slot 3 specifically or render that one tag with dark text. Most consumers use slots 1-2 for tags and 3-12 for marks/wedges where the AA bar doesn't apply.

Open decisions

- 1. The other 12 themes.** If route 2 is right, we copy old `--chart-*` + `--cat-*` into `--c1-dark..--c12-dark` per theme. cuoio's old palette is leather-toned (saddle, parchment, gold-wash); brina was steel-blue + champagne; burgundy was wine + forest. Each theme keeps its *actual* brand voice.
- 2. Achromatic themes.** onyx / ardesia / concrete don't have an old `--chart-*` tier rich enough to map — they shipped at near-zero chroma. The staggered tonal cycle we just landed for them stays.
- 3. The audit's role.** The audit deck stays as the historical record of the AA-text-optimized direction. Route 2 explicitly walks back from that optimization for the deep tier. Worth noting in the commit message.
- 4. Slot 5 (mustard gold).** It's L=70 — pairs with dark text, not white. If shipped layouts expect "every `--cN-dark` takes white text," slot 5 is the one place to verify. Decision-list at slot 5: lightest text would need `--c-ink-light`, not `--c-ink-dark`. Manageable but the contract becomes "slot-dependent text colour."